

What Year One really costs

The honest budget page. No fee figures are printed here because they change by state and year; the structure below does not.

01 THE FOUR BUCKETS

Registration: state brand and label fees, per brand, per state, renewed annually.

Samples: bottles and freight for buyers, tastings and laboratory checks.

The duty float: customs duty and state charges on your first consignment are paid before the first sale comes in. Cash-flow this, not just cost it.

Launch marketing: tastings, staff training and the festive push.

02 THE MARKETING REALITY

Direct alcohol advertising is banned in India. No billboards, no paid media for the liquid. Money that works: on-trade tastings, bartender training and advocacy, menu placements, curated events, and duty-free visibility.

Budget people, not impressions. In this market a trained bartender pouring your serve is worth more than any advertisement you are not allowed to run.

03 WHAT SCALES THE BILL

Each extra state repeats registration and fees. Each extra SKU repeats label work. Narrowness is not caution; it is arithmetic.

04 THE NARROW PLAN · UNDER USD 25,000

The shape: one state, one season, one lead SKU, done completely. Roughly half of this cohort will run it, and it works.

Months 1 to 3: documents, trademark filing, importer agreement, label registration submitted.

Months 4 to 6: first consignment, bonded stock, over-labelling, trade tastings begin.

Months 7 to 9: the festive quarter: on-trade push, gifting placements, reorder conversation. July decides November: the label clock (up to four to five months in some states) makes this calendar honest.

THE POINT

Budget the four buckets before the first invoice. In Phase 3 we cost your exact plan, state by state, on your numbers.